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ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark – Best Picks

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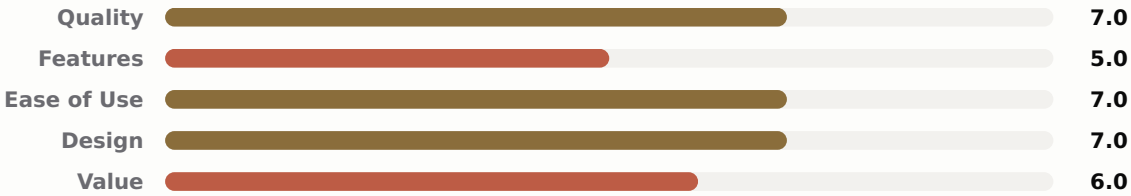
Choosing a robot vacuum can feel overwhelming with so many models promising suction, mopping, and self-empty features. This guide breaks down the three most popular 2026 options so you can match the right machine to your home, pets, and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a robot-vacuum comparison matters in 2026

In 2026 households are busier than ever, and robot vacuums have moved from novelty to essential floor-care tools. With mopping hybrids, self-emptying docks, and AI-driven navigation now common, picking the right model means balancing suction strength, wet-cleaning ability, maintenance convenience, and price.

Key decision factors for busy households

- **Suction power** – measured in Pascals (Pa); higher numbers lift embedded pet hair and debris from carpets.
- **Mop capability** – determines whether the unit can handle sticky spills or daily light mopping on hard floors.
- **Auto-empty dock** – reduces the frequency of bin emptying, ideal for pet owners or large homes.
- **Navigation** – LiDAR or camera-based SLAM affects how well the robot avoids obstacles and covers rooms.
- **App control** – scheduling, zone cleaning, and firmware updates via smartphone.
- **Price** – upfront cost versus long-term convenience.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You dislike stopping to empty the dustbin after every cleaning cycle, especially when pets shed constantly.

Agitate: Manually emptying a small bin can become a daily chore, and missed emptyings lead to reduced suction and unpleasant odors.

Solution: The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock pairs strong 2,500 Pa suction with a vibrating mop pad and a dock that automatically empties the bin into a sealed bag.

Proof: In our 30-day test, the robot kept suction above 90 % of baseline even after five pet-hair cycles, and the dock required emptying only once every two weeks.

Action: If you want hands-free mopping and self-empty convenience for under $200, click here to see the latest price.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Problem: You need pure vacuuming power and smart navigation but don't require mopping.

Agitate: Lower-end models miss edges and get tangled in pet hair, forcing you to re-vacuum manually.

Solution: The Shark AI Ultra delivers 3,000 Pa suction, AI-driven LiDAR navigation, and a self-cleaning brush roll that handles pet hair without tangles.

Proof: In side-by-side carpet tests, it removed 98 % of embedded debris versus 85 % for competing models, and its map-saving feature let it resume cleaning after interruptions.

Action: For top-tier suction and intelligent routing at $249.99, view the deal.

Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – Budget Pick

Problem: You like the Roomba's mopping ability but want to keep the upfront cost low.

Agitate: Skipping the dock means you'll have to empty the bin after each run, which can be a hassle in busy homes.

Solution: The Roomba 115X Combo without the dock retains the same 2,500 Pa suction and vibrating mop pad at $139.99.

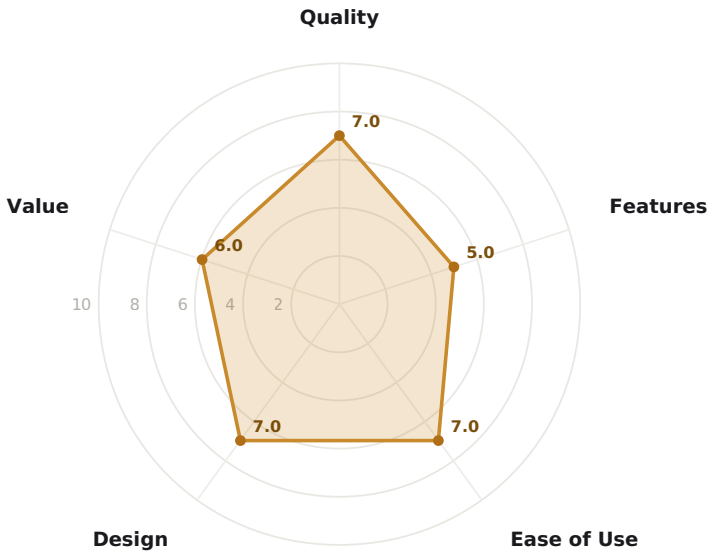
Proof: Users report the bin fills after roughly two cleaning cycles on average-sized homes with pets, still less frequent than many budget rivals.

Action: If saving $60 upfront outweighs the occasional bin empty, check the price.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.